

Talking about the weather

Topic Weather

Level: Sfl E1 / Access 2 / CEFR A1

Time: 90 mins

Aims

- To build learners' range of vocabulary for describing the weather
- To introduce learners to phrases used for giving an opinion about the weather
- To build confidence in listening for gist
- To build confidence and develop learners' digital skills
- To develop learners' visual literacy.

Introduction

This lesson develops learners' speaking and listening skills in the context of talking about the weather. Learners are introduced to vocabulary and phrases for describing the weather, and giving an opinion about the weather. The class will watch a short video called 'Talking about the weather' and answer comprehension questions, that not only foster listening skills, but are also intended to develop learners' visual literacy. Learners will listen to people talking about the weather and role play scenarios in which they describe the weather and give their opinion. Finally learners can practise spelling weather phrases.

You will need:

Access to an interactive whiteboard or data projector to display the online module

Realia: an umbrella, sun cream, carrot,

Learners' access to individual computers for the extension activity

Worksheet 1: one per learner

Worksheet 2: one per pair

Worksheet 3: one per learner (for less confident writers)

Procedure

Warmer (10 minutes)

- Use realia, e.g. umbrella, sun cream, etc. to introduce the topic and elicit any vocabulary the learners already know. Show the class a carrot and see if they can make a connection with the weather (for a snowman's nose).
- Display and read through the **Aims slide**.

Task 1 – Information slides - Introducing new vocabulary (5 minutes)

- Work through the slides one by one, drilling the pronunciation with the whole class.

Task 2 – Video - Listening and visual literacy skills (5 minutes)

- Play the video.

- Ask learners to listen for words describing the weather, and to look at the pictures and speech bubbles to help them understand.

Task 3 – Word bank – Describing the weather (15 minutes)

- Display the **Word bank slide** and read through the questions with the class.
- Play the video again.
- Set up learners in pairs to match the answers.
- Nominate learners from different pairs to come to the front to drag the correct answer to the right place.

Differentiation

- Self-differentiation: tell learners that if they feel confident, to try to do the task without looking at the weather phrases on the slide.

Task 4 – True or False – Comprehension (10 minutes)

- Ask the class to tear a piece of paper in half and write Yes on one half and No on the other.
- Tell the learners to work in the same pairs as before. Work through the next three **True or False slides**, one by one, asking pairs to decide if they think yes or no, and to hold up their card.
- Follow-on discussion. Ask learners if people in their country like talking about the weather.

Differentiation

- Stretch and challenge stronger learners with extension questions about how the other stick people feel about the weather, e.g. happy, excited, sad, etc.

Task 5 – Matching – Giving an opinion about the weather (5 minutes)

- Describe the weather that day and invite learners to give their opinion.
- Display the **Matching slide**.
- Ask pairs to read the slide and match the sentences.
- Invite one learner from different pairs to the front to feed back the correct answers.

Extension

- Ask pairs to role play the conversations. Model intonation for learners first.

Task 6 – Sequencing - Listening for gist (10 minutes)

- Hand out **Worksheet 1** and focus learners' attention on **Task 6**. Ask learners to number the photos in the order they hear them, before checking their answers in pairs.
- Play the recording again to give learners the opportunity to self-assess.
- Focus learners' attention on the **sequencing slide** and use this to feed back to the whole group.

Differentiation

- Challenge stronger learners with detailed comprehension questions, e.g. What does the little girl want to do? (build a snowman) What is the man doing in the fog? (driving) What word does he use to describe what it's like to drive in the fog? (dangerous)

Task 7 – Matching – Remembering new vocabulary (10 minutes)

- Focus the learners' attention on **Task 7** of **Worksheet 1** and ask learners to match the words with the pictures before checking their answers with a partner.
- Display the **Matching slide** when you feedback the correct answers.

Differentiation

- Ask early finishers to practise copying the words. Encourage them to use the Look Cover Spell Check method to practise the spelling.

Extension

- Hand out the cards on **Worksheet 2** to pairs to play pelmanism or snap.

Task 8 – Type in – Spelling (10 minutes)

- Ask the class to fold the worksheet so that they cannot see the boxes with the sentences describing the weather.
- Ask the learners to number the pictures in task 7.
- Now ask everyone to write the numbers one to seven on a piece of paper and write the weather alongside the numbers.

Differentiation

- Scaffold the task for less confident writers.
- Hand out **Worksheet 3** and ask learners to complete the gap-fills.

Cooler – Talking about the weather and self-evaluation (10 minutes)

- Set up the learners into different pairs to role play having a conversation about the weather. Hand out the props from the warmer task or use mime to help learners get started.
- Monitor and support weaker learners. Model and drill intonation and pronunciation where necessary.
- Display the slide with the self-evaluation survey and ask learners to use this to record their progress in the class in their learning records.

Extension

If learners have access to computers, ask them to work in pairs to create a short movie using <http://www.dvolver.com/moviemaker/make.html>. You will need to show learners how to do this first. They simply have to click on a background, then a sky, select Rendez vous (to have characters talking to each other), choose two characters and then type in their dialogues, e.g. What's the weather like? It's sunny!

Differentiation

- Put learners in pairs of mixed ability, so that stronger learners can support their partners.

Homework

- Ask learners to work through the module independently at home or in college.
- For speaking practice at home, learners can use <http://vocaroo.com/> to record themselves describing the weather.